

alization software; it runs operating systems. Gathering advanced debugging info about running the running OS is useful for the guys deep into code and a lot of memory junk that comes along. Not at all meant for the average user, it's one of those features that set VMware Workstation apart from others especially when it comes with so many other useful features. These features (except Autoresize) are available in the virtual machine's settings window's "Options" tab. To open it, select the tab and go to **VM > Settings** on the main window or you can also right-click the VM's name in the library pane and select the "Settings" option at the bottom. In addition to the above, you can change a few things about the virtual hardware on the "Hardware" tab of the VM's settings window. You can add or remove new storage media, network cards, audio and USB ports and so on; after all, they are all "virtual"! However, you can't remove the Processor, Memory or Display. You can only change the settings – adding more cores to the virtual processor available to your machine, increasing / decreasing the amount of memory to be consumed and acceleration of 3D graphics and setting resolutions of the display. Also note that when the virtual machine is running, you can't add new hardware. You can only enable or disable a few of them. If you're able to add a few new hardware components such as hard disk or dvd/cd drive, you'll only be able to use them upon rebooting the virtual machine. This is because you can't do that on a real system as well and the operating systems are designed assuming that you don't pull out your RAM modules from the CPU when the system is running or do something as crazy as that!

- **Note for Linux users:** At times, VMware complains that a particular module is not loaded, just when you press the start button for the virtual machine. The error would typically inform you which module was not loaded. In such scenarios, you can switch to the root account (run the **su** command) and load those modules with the **modprobe** command.



Figure 13: VMware workstation complaining the unavailability of the vmmon kernel module

Once the command runs successfully, you can retry starting the machine and it should work! If it doesn't, run to the internet forums or the VMware support team for help!

You can disconnect and reconnect a few virtual hardware while the guest OS is running. You can right-click the activity icons at the bottom right corner of the VMware